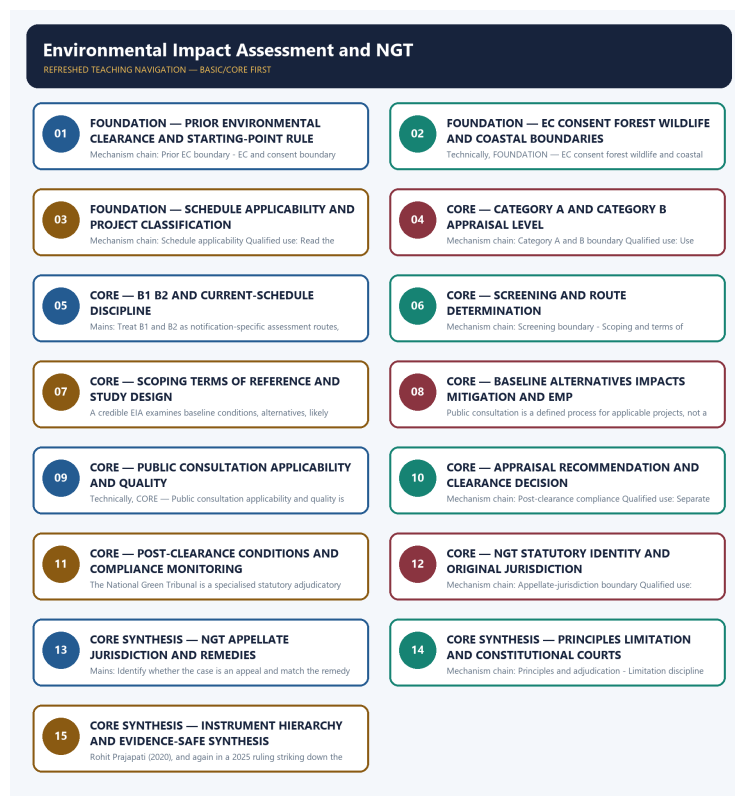


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Prior EC boundary?	5
Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Prior EC boundary?	5
Q3. Which statement uses Prior EC boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	5
Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Prior EC boundary?	6
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies EC and consent boundary?	6
Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of EC and consent boundary?	6
Q7. Which statement uses EC and consent boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	6
Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about EC and consent boundary?	7
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Multiple-clearance boundary?	7
Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Multiple-clearance boundary?	7
Q11. Which statement uses Multiple-clearance boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	7
Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Multiple-clearance boundary?	8
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule applicability?	8
Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule applicability?	8
Q15. Which statement uses Schedule applicability without changing its scale, parameter or status?	8
Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule applicability?	9
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category A and B boundary?	9
Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category A and B boundary?	9
Q19. Which statement uses Category A and B boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	9
Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category A and B boundary?	10
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies B1 and B2 boundary?	10
Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of B1 and B2 boundary?	10
Q23. Which statement uses B1 and B2 boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	10
Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about B1 and B2 boundary?	11
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Screening boundary?	11
Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Screening boundary?	11
Q27. Which statement uses Screening boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	11

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Screening boundary?	12
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Scoping and terms of reference?	12
Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Scoping and terms of reference?	12
Q31. Which statement uses Scoping and terms of reference without changing its scale, parameter or status?	12
Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Scoping and terms of reference?	13
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment evidence?	13
Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment evidence?	13
Q35. Which statement uses Assessment evidence without changing its scale, parameter or status?	13
Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment evidence?	14
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Public-consultation boundary?	14
Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Public-consultation boundary?	14
Q39. Which statement uses Public-consultation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	14
Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Public-consultation boundary?	15
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Appraisal and decision?	15
Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appraisal and decision?	15
Q43. Which statement uses Appraisal and decision without changing its scale, parameter or status?	15
Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appraisal and decision?	16
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Post-clearance compliance?	16
Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Post-clearance compliance?	16
Q47. Which statement uses Post-clearance compliance without changing its scale, parameter or status?	17
Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Post-clearance compliance?	17
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies NGT statutory identity?	17
Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NGT statutory identity?	17
Q51. Which statement uses NGT statutory identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?	18
Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NGT statutory identity?	18
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Original-jurisdiction boundary?	18
Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Original-jurisdiction boundary?	18
Q55. Which statement uses Original-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	19
Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Original-jurisdiction boundary?	19
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?	19
Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?	20
Q59. Which statement uses Appellate-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	20

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?	20
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Remedy boundary?	20
Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Remedy boundary?	21
Q63. Which statement uses Remedy boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	21
Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Remedy boundary?	21
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Principles and adjudication?	21
Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Principles and adjudication?	22
Q67. Which statement uses Principles and adjudication without changing its scale, parameter or status?	22
Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Principles and adjudication?	22
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Limitation discipline?	22
Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Limitation discipline?	23
Q71. Which statement uses Limitation discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?	23
Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Limitation discipline?	23
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Constitutional-court boundary?	23
Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Constitutional-court boundary?	24
Q75. Which statement uses Constitutional-court boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	24
Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Constitutional-court boundary?	24
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Instrument and evidence boundary?	24
Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Instrument and evidence boundary?	25
Q79. Which statement uses Instrument and evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	25
Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Instrument and evidence boundary?	25

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 25

AUDITED EIA, CLEARANCE, NGT AND ENVIRONMENTAL-JUSTICE PYQ OWNERSHIP	26
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	31
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	33
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	36
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	39
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	44

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT - Solved Practice Workbook

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. Uses the same source-bounded ecological distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Prior EC boundary?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: A. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Prior EC boundary?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: B. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Prior EC boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: C. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Prior EC boundary?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: D. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies EC and consent boundary?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: A. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of EC and consent boundary?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses EC and consent boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: C. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about EC and consent boundary?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: D. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Multiple-clearance boundary?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: A. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Multiple-clearance boundary?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: B. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Multiple-clearance boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: C. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Multiple-clearance boundary?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. C. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: D. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule applicability?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: A. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule applicability?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: B. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Schedule applicability without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule applicability?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: D. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category A and B boundary?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: A. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category A and B boundary?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Category A and B boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments

or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category A and B boundary?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: D. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies B1 and B2 boundary?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of B1 and B2 boundary?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses B1 and B2 boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current

schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about B1 and B2 boundary?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: D. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Screening boundary?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. C. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Screening boundary?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Screening boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: C. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The

other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Screening boundary?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: D. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Scoping and terms of reference?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Scoping and terms of reference?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: B. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Scoping and terms of reference without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: C. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Scoping and terms of reference?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: D. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment evidence?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: A. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment evidence?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: B. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Assessment evidence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: C. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment evidence?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: D. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Public-consultation boundary?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: A. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Public-consultation boundary?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: B. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Public-consultation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: C. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current

notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Public-consultation boundary?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Appraisal and decision?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: A. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appraisal and decision?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: B. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Appraisal and decision without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appraisal and decision?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Post-clearance compliance?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: A. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Post-clearance compliance?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. D. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Post-clearance compliance without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: C. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Post-clearance compliance?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: D. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies NGT statutory identity?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. D. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NGT statutory identity?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options

belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses NGT statutory identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NGT statutory identity?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Original-jurisdiction boundary?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: A. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Original-jurisdiction boundary?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: B. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Original-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: C. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Original-jurisdiction boundary?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: D. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: A. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: B. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Appellate-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: C. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: D. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Remedy boundary?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Remedy boundary?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: B. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Remedy boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: C. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Remedy boundary?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Principles and adjudication?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Principles and adjudication?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Principles and adjudication without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Principles and adjudication?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Limitation discipline?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: A. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other

options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Limitation discipline?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: B. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Limitation discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: C. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Limitation discipline?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Constitutional-court boundary?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Constitutional-court boundary?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Constitutional-court boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Constitutional-court boundary?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Instrument and evidence boundary?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: A. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Instrument and evidence boundary?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: B. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Instrument and evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: C. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Instrument and evidence boundary?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: D. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED EIA, CLEARANCE, NGT AND ENVIRONMENTAL-JUSTICE PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route direct Mains demands on EIA reform, NGO and activist influence, mining hazards and constitutional environmental adjudication, plus objective distinctions between NGT and CPCB and Environment Protection Act powers. No answer key is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 GS-III direct PYQ**: role of environmental NGOs/activists in influencing EIA outcomes, requiring **four properly sourced examples**.
- FACT: **2025 GS-III cross-route**: mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures; use this file for EIA/clearance/closure governance and Geography topic 31 for mineral occurrence. Exact routes: . . /README . md.
- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: distinguish Category A/B/B1/B2 clearance requirements and identify the four EIA process stages correctly.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: NGT case examples are used to illustrate the application of the Polluter Pays and Precautionary Principles in Indian environmental jurisprudence.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025 . md.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	8	Role of environmental NGOs and activists in EIA outcomes	Cite examples · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2025	GS-III	17	Mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Role of environmental NGOs and activists in EIA outcomes
- Mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023 . md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023 . md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023 . md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022

- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II, GS-III, Prelims GS-I

- **Routed question demands: 6**

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	4	National Green Tribunal versus Central Pollution Control Board	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Cross-routed to environmental specialist and tribunal-versus-regulator classification; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-I	15	Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts	How can it be restored · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	Prelims GS-I	58	Environment Protection Act 1986 Government of India powers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	GS-III	7	Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification	How does · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	1	Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court	Discuss with case laws · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; judicial review and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- National Green Tribunal versus Central Pollution Control Board
- Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts
- Environment Protection Act 1986 Government of India powers
- Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification
- Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-III direct PYQ:** NGOs/activists influencing EIA outcomes, with four evidence-backed examples-not generic advocacy claims.

- **FACT: 2025 GS-III cross-route:** mining hazard/remedies; analyse appraisal, compliance, reclamation and mine closure here, with resource geography in Geography topic 31. Exact routes: . . /README . md.

- **ANALYSIS:** Prelims questions on NGT jurisdiction should be answered by applying the specified-statute-schedule rule rather than assuming unlimited environmental jurisdiction.

- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "EIA effectiveness" or "NGT's role" should explicitly engage the post-facto-clearance controversy and the implementation-capacity limitation to demonstrate analytical depth beyond a purely descriptive account.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II, GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-I	15	Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts	How can it be restored · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-III	7	Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification	How does · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	1	Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court	Discuss with case laws · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; judicial review and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts
- Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification
- Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish prior environmental clearance from pollution-control consent. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental

mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.
- Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.
- Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish prior environmental clearance from pollution-control consent. Answer in about 150...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish prior environmental clearance from pollution-control consent. Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.
- Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.
- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
- An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects

clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale,

stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the evidence chain from baseline study to post-clearance monitoring. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the

owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.
- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
- An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.
- A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the evidence chain from baseline study to post-clearance monitoring. Answer in about...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status,

metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory

scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the evidence chain from baseline study to post-clearance monitoring. Answer in about...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish NGT original and appellate jurisdiction. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

- NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.
- NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.
- The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish NGT original and appellate jurisdiction. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim

examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final

minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish NGT original and appellate jurisdiction. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate India's preventive EIA and corrective NGT architecture. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status,

metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.
- The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.
- Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.
- A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.
- A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.
- The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.
- Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.
- Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution

of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate India's preventive EIA and corrective NGT architecture. Answer in about 300 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable

development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate India's preventive EIA and corrective NGT architecture. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named

law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Build a legally disciplined project-clearance and remedy answer. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status,

metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.
- Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.
- Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.
- The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.
- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
- NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.
- NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.
- Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.
- An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal

link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Build a legally disciplined project-clearance and remedy answer. Answer in about 300 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone

does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale,

stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

7. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
9. **Claim and named evidence:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the

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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Build a legally disciplined project-clearance and remedy answer. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.